

# Describing company processes

COMMUNICATION

LEVEL  
Upper-intermediate

NUMBER  
EN\_BE\_3121X

LANGUAGE  
English

lingoda

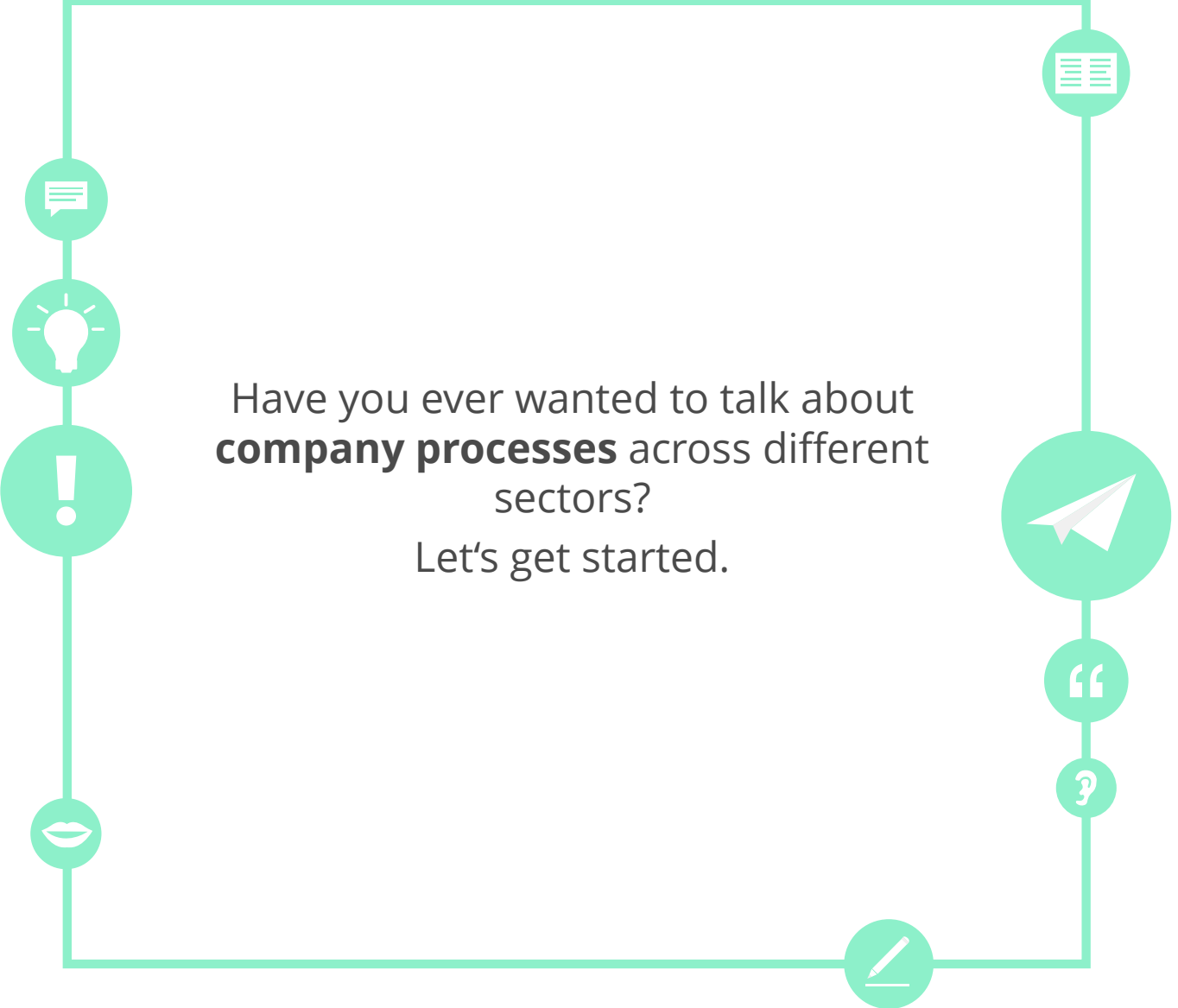




## Goals

- Can understand and use typical vocabulary to describe company processes across different sectors
- Can clearly describe own company's processes using the passive voice and linking words and phrases





Have you ever wanted to talk about  
**company processes** across different  
sectors?  
Let's get started.



## Preview and warm-up

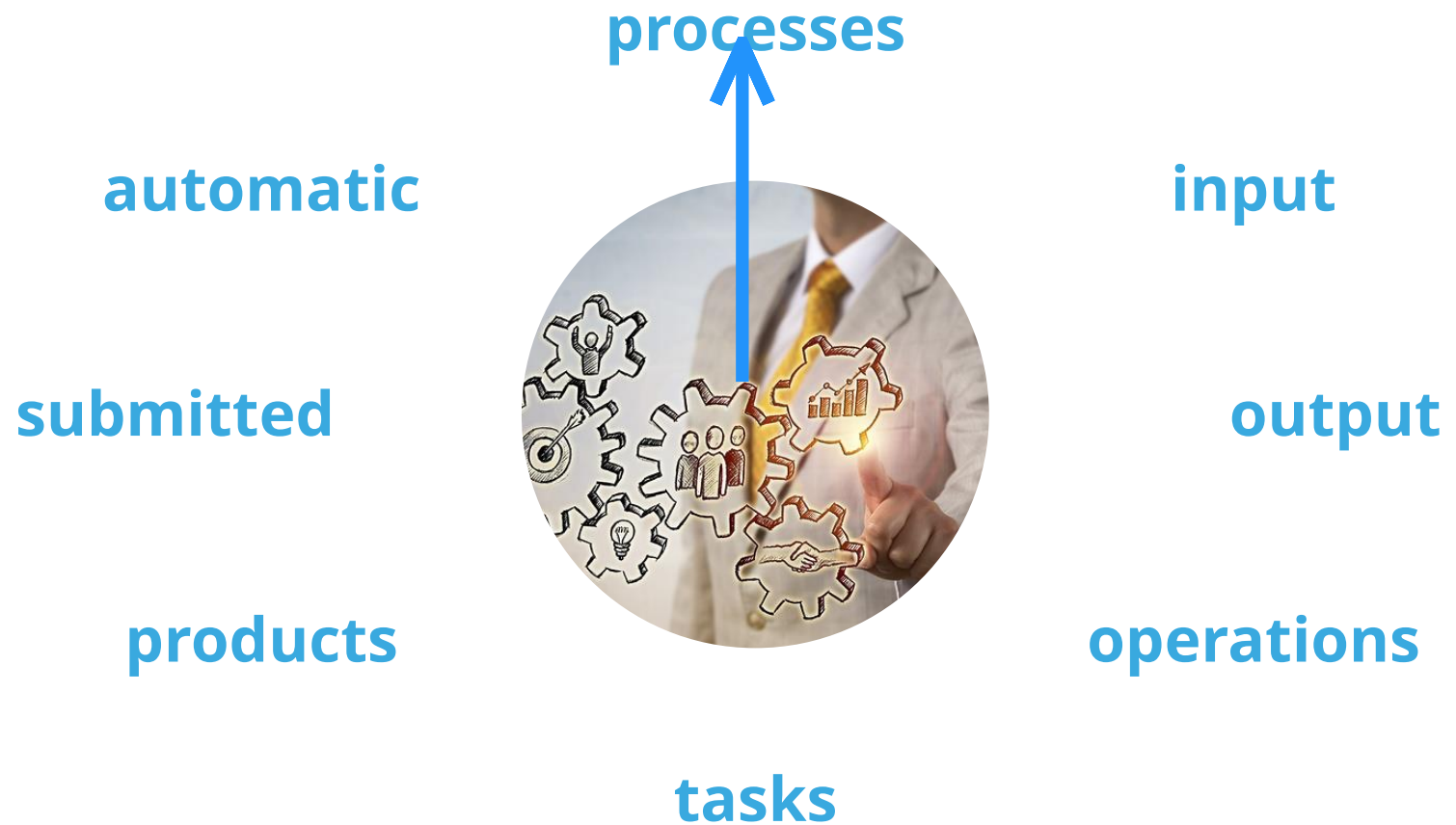
- In this lesson, you will learn how to describe **company processes** in English.



The rolls of steel **are loaded** onto a tray in the **third stage** of processing.



## Describing company processes





## Describing company processes



**Processes** are a series of steps or actions taken to achieve a goal.

Things that are added to a system are called **inputs**.



The **outputs** of a process are the results of processing.

A company's **operations** describe what they do in producing their product or service.





## Describing company processes



A **task** is a piece of work or action that is being or must be completed.

A **product** is something that is produced or manufactured for sale.



A job application is **submitted** to an employer.

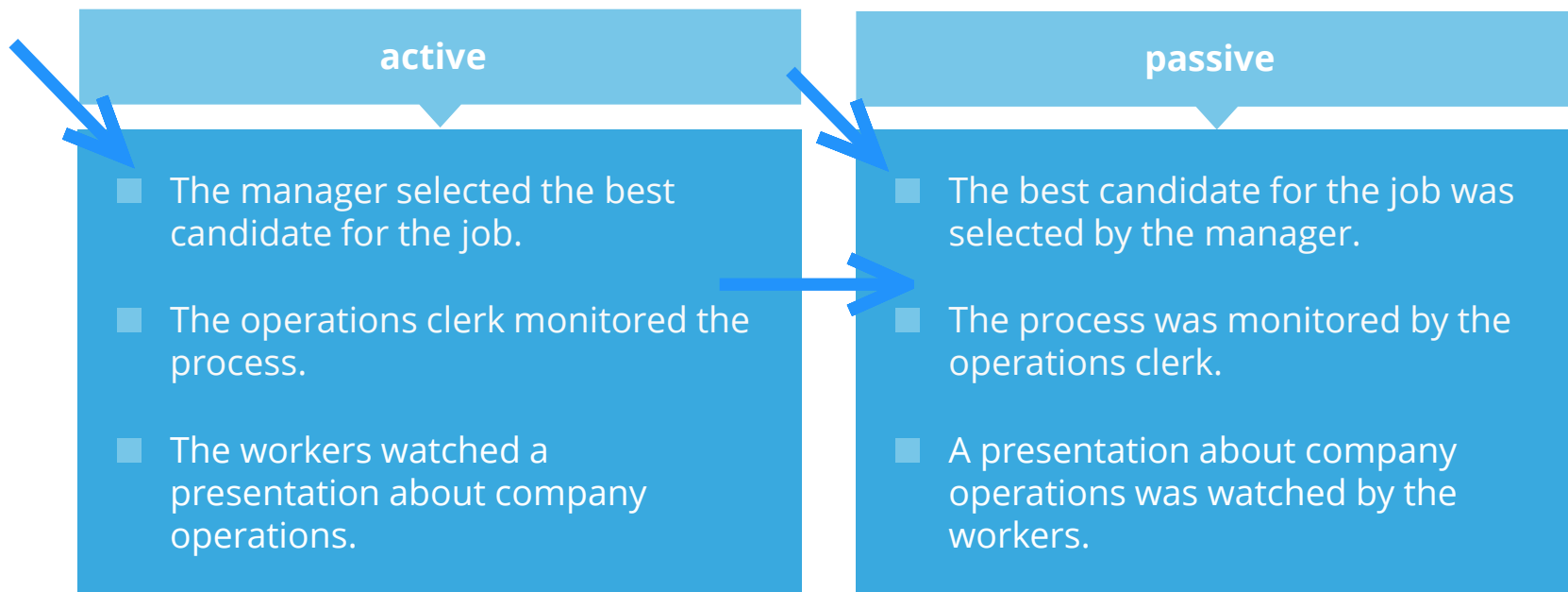
An **automatic** process occurs without human intervention.





## Review of the passive voice for describing outcomes

- The **passive voice** is used when the **subject** of the sentence is the **receiver** of an action.
- The **passive voice** emphasises **the result of an action** whereas **the active voice** emphasises **who/what performed** the action.





## Formation of the passive

- **The passive** is formed using the appropriate form of the verb **'to be' + past participle**  
The class **was taken**.
- **The subject** that has performed the action is not always stated in a passive sentence. This is because the passive emphasises what happened as a **result of the action**.
- For example: The wall was painted

Verb      Past form of verb      Past participle

Paint      Painted      Painted





## More about the passive voice (Be + Past Participle)

- Remember that the **passive voice** is used with **different tenses**.

**Present simple:** The manager **chooses** the best product. → The best product **is chosen** by the manager.

**Present continuous:** They **are delivering** the inputs at the moment. → The inputs **are being delivered** at the moment.

**present perfect continuous**

**Simple past:** The company **announced** that the process would be done automatically in future. → It **was announced** by the company that the process would be done automatically in future.

**Past continuous:** The managers **were interviewing** the workers in order to understand how the manufacturing process worked. → The workers **were being interviewed** by the managers in order to understand how the manufacturing process worked.

**past perfect continuous**



## More examples of passive and active sentences using different tenses



The process worker manually **loads** the products onto the conveyor belt.

The products **are** manually **loaded** onto the conveyor belt by the process worker.



The operations team **performed** a series of checks on the machinery each morning.

A series of checks on the machinery **was performed** by the operations team each morning.





## More examples of passive and active sentences using different tenses



The receptionist **is writing** the invoice.

An invoice **is being written** by the receptionist.



They **were conducting** an audit at the time of the malfunction.

An audit **was being conducted** at the time of the malfunction.





## Transform these active sentences into passive sentences

S  
1. The Human Resources Manager changed the billing period to every fortnight. O



The billing period was changed by the Human Resources Manager to every fortnight. S

2. The assembly workers are cleaning the vents.



The vents are being cleaned by the assembly workers.

3. At the time of the accident, the auditors were examining a report.



A report was being examined by auditors, at the time of the accident.

4. The company directors agreed to hire a new CEO.



The hiring of a new CEO was agreed to by the company directors.

5. The finance department processes all invoicing requests.



All invoicing requests are processed by the finance department.



## Transform these sentences from active into passive

1. The first step of the process initiates the next step.



~~The next step is initiated by the first step of the process.~~

2. The manager is reviewing the billing process.



~~The billing process is being reviewed by the manager.~~

3. A distributor transports the raw materials to the port.



~~The raw materials to the port are transported by the distributor.~~

4. The shipping company only accepts packaged goods.



~~Packaged goods are accepted by the shipping company.~~

5. Logistics announced a new plan for wholesale distribution.



~~A new plan for wholesale distribution was announced by logistics.~~



# Describing different types of company processes

What is the difference between manual and automatic processes?  
Can you think of any manual processes that have over time been replaced by automatic processes?

When you are describing these processes, outline what inputs are used to create an output.



Automatic



Manual



Inputs



Outputs

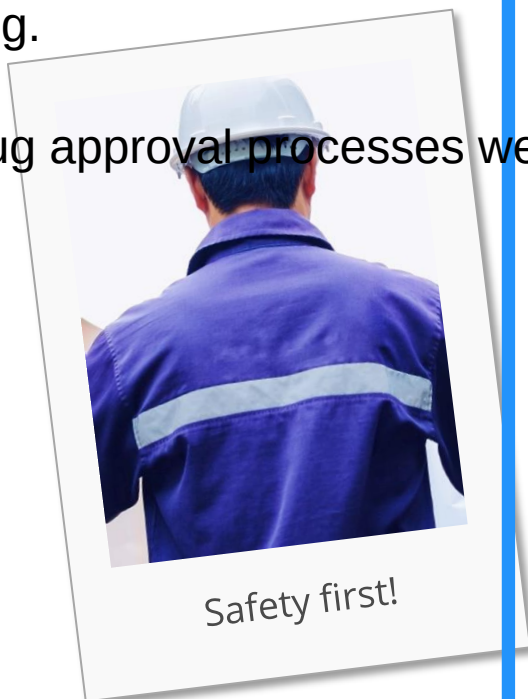


## Describing company processes

What types of jobs employ these processes? Choose at least 3 and describe how the processes work in organisations you know of. Where possible, describe the outcome of the process using the passive voice.

Risk management processes were conducted by the safety manager of the building.

The drug approval processes were controlled





## Describing company processes

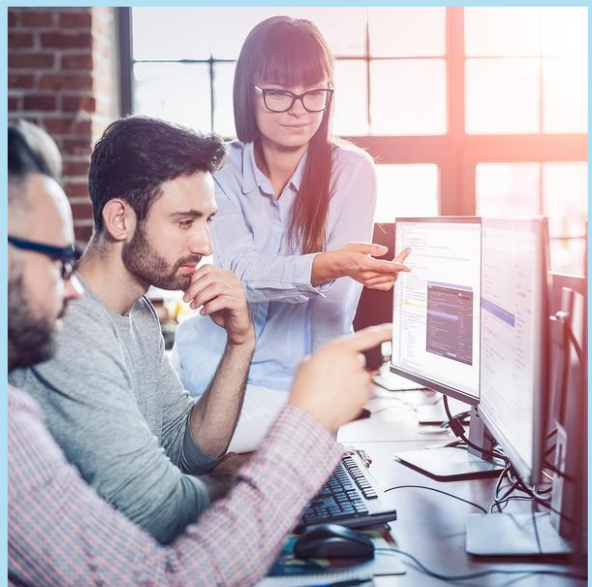
Fire drills and safety processes.

Product quality assurance and regulations.

**Can you think of any  
other types of  
company processes?**



## Describing your company processes



Describe the company processes used in your current job.

Outline what your company does and your role within the company.

Either your teacher or your classmates will prepare some questions to ask you.



## Describing company processes

**accomplish**

**Verb:** means to **successfully achieve** something.

I have **accomplished** many things in my career, including successfully integrating automation across our company's processes.

**organisation**

**Noun:** refers to a **group of people** who **come together** for a particular purpose.

The **organisation** running the lifts has fine-tuned the processing of cable car replacements.

**human  
resources**

**Noun:** the **department** of an organisation responsible for **hiring** and **training** of employees.

If you have a problem with your work contract, you have to speak to **human resources (HR)**.

**target**

**Noun:** a **goal** to achieve.

The company's **targets** are aligned with global trends in finance.



## Describing company processes

**allocate**

**Verb:** means to **distribute** something for a purpose.

The manager **allocated** tasks to the employees based on their skills and experience.

**responsible for**

**Adjective:** means to have an **obligation** to do something which is under one's **control or care**.

He is **responsible for** maintaining machine upgrades.

**goal**

**Noun:** something that is being **aimed at** as a result of one's effort or ambition.

The company's **goal** is to increase revenue by 50% over the next 5 years.

**deadline**

Noun: the **latest time** by which something must be **completed**.

The project **deadline** is November 5<sup>th</sup>.

**objective**

**Noun:** Something that is **aimed for**; a **goal**.

Our **objective** is to establish a company and achieve steady growth over the next ten years.



## Describing company processes

stage

**Noun:** a **point** or **step** in a process

The second **stage** of the manufacturing process is crucial.

step

**Noun:** a **stage** in a process.

The next **step** is to ensure that we achieve a high level of financing for the project.

in-house

**Adjective:** done by **employees of an organisation** as opposed to by **outside contractors**.

We have an **in-house** legal team who deals with all complaints.

short-term  
long-term

**Adjective:** occurring over a **short** or **long** period of time.

Our **short-term goals** are very achievable, but we are yet to see if **our long-term goals** are within reach.



## Asking and answering questions using target vocabulary.





Company processes often face challenges. Which of these have you experienced? Can you think of any others?

## Integration issues

bottlenecks and  
quality assurance  
problems

**technical  
failures**

fierce  
competition

inadequate  
staff training

duplication

**communication  
breakdowns**

a lack of performance  
indicators

**tight  
deadlines**

redundancy across a  
system



# Discussing challenges and solutions in company processes

What types of challenges do these areas of business face? What are the solutions to these problems? Are any of these problems unsolvable?



1

**Logistics:** distribution, supply, delivery, handling and ordering.

2

**Sales and Marketing:** customer service, customer complaints, marketing strategies and target markets.

3

**Manufacturing:** Product assembly processes, quality assurance, corrective and preventative maintenance.





## Role playing problem solving in logistics

Imagine you are the manager of a big distribution company supplying fruit and vegetables to nearby countries by ship. A new tax has been implemented over the last 3 months which has led to large delays at the port. This has led to a bottleneck of trucks needing to be unloaded. Due to the increased travel time, more raw products are going off as they sit at the port waiting to be loaded onto ships.

Role play a conversation with your logistics team who oversees the delivery of the raw materials to the port via trucks. How are you going to solve the bottleneck problem?





## Describing processes with linking words

To begin with,  
To start with,  
Firstly

This phrase can be used to describe the **first stage** in a process.

Secondly,  
Thirdly,

Use these words to describe the **in-between** stages of a process.

Then,  
Afterwards,  
Subsequently

Use these words to **move on** to the **next** stage.

Moreover,  
Furthermore,  
In addition

These words can be used when you want to give **further information** about a particular stage of a process.

Lastly,  
Finally

These words signal the **final** stage of a process.

To conclude,  
To summarise

This phrase can be used when you want to summarise a process.



## More examples of commonly-used linking phrases used in complex descriptions

### **To reinforce a point:**

Above all  
Especially  
Furthermore  
What is more  
Moreover

### **To make comparisons:**

In the same way  
Likewise  
Similarly  
Equally

### **To provide results: differently:**

As a consequence  
As a result  
Accordingly  
For this reason

### **To make a concession:**

Admittedly  
After all  
Even so  
Under certain circumstances  
Notwithstanding

### **To draw a contrast:**

By way of contrast  
Conversely  
On the contrary  
In reality

### **To express something**

In other words  
That is to say  
To put it more simply



## Using linking phrases to describe company processes

Using linking phrases from the previous two slides, describe a company process that you know of. Then, provide an outline of how this process is likely to develop in the next five years. Make some notes and then share your answers with your classmates/teacher.

Admittedly, the process hasn't changed much in recent years, but this doesn't mean that it won't change in future.

In other words, the process has become digitised rather than automatised.





## The future of business processes

**How do you think  
business processes  
will change in the  
future?**

More  
automation.

More  
international.

The basics  
won't change.



## Reflect on the goals

Go back to the second slide of the lesson and check if you have achieved all the goals of the lesson.

yes

no





## Reflect on this lesson

Think about everything you have seen in this lesson.  
What were the most difficult activities or words? The easiest?



If you have time, go over  
the most difficult slides again



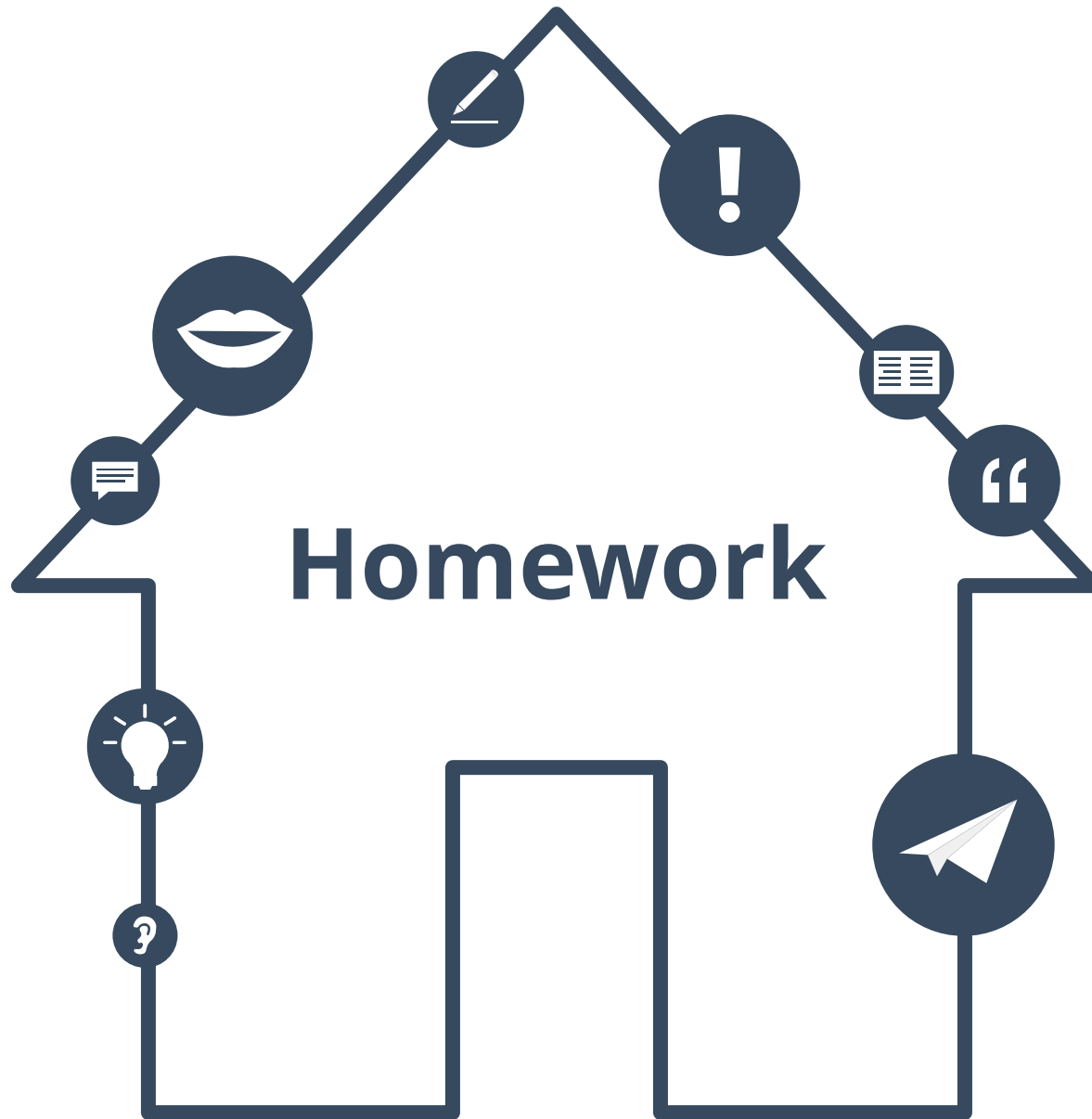
## Answer key

### Exercise p. 14

The second step of the process is initiated by the first step and so on. The billing process is being reviewed by the manager. The raw materials are transported to the port by a distributor. Only packaged goods are accepted by the shipping company. A new plan for wholesale distribution was announced by logistics.

### Exercise p. 13

The vents are being cleaned by the assembly workers. At the time of the accident, a report was being examined by the auditors. The hiring of a new CEO was agreed to by the company directors. All invoicing requests are processed by the finance department.





## Practise writing an e-mail to explain a problem

**Practise writing an e-mail to your manager outlining a problem that you are having in your company and a solution that you would like to recommend. Use a formal voice and where appropriate use the passive voice.**

-

□

×

To: mrjones@mail.com

Subject: Update on logistics supply

Dear Mr Jones,

I am writing to inform you of a problem we currently experiencing in logistics.  
The problem is as follows:...



## More practice with the active and passive voice

**Write two sentences for each word with the active and passive voice. Once you have finished, try describing a process using linking words and passive sentences to highlight the outcomes of the process.**





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